

SHIP WITHOUT SANDBOXES

Build in VS Code, install from the IDE

A full round trip for a Fluent app with no developer sandbox anywhere in it. GitHub carries the code, the ServiceNow IDE installs it, and edits made on the instance come back as Fluent source rather than XML.

BEFORE YOU START

- Node and the ServiceNow SDK installed locally
- A GitHub repo and a fine grained PAT scoped to it
- An instance with the ServiceNow IDE available
- An app in **global scope**, see the scope note on page 2

01 Build locally, install nothing

VS Code, Fluent, no instance touched

```
npm run build
```

Fluent, written by your agent of choice. Build proves it compiles. Do not install.

02 Push to GitHub

The repo becomes the source of truth

```
git push -u origin main
```

03 Clone into the ServiceNow IDE

Not Studio, and not an update set

ServiceNow IDE → add an application → Clone Git repository

Repo URL, username, fine grained PAT. The IDE clones onto the instance and wires up Git.

04 Build and Install

Status bar, bottom of the IDE

Build and Install

The instance builds and installs from its own clone. Your laptop installed nothing.

05 Add an artifact from VS Code

New Flow Designer action, in Fluent

```
npm run build && npm run deploy && git push  
IDE → Pull → Build and Install
```

Pulling changes nothing on the instance. The install is what makes the action usable.

06 Edit on the instance

Build agent, inside the IDE

Build agent → edit the Fluent object → Build and Install →
commit → push

Why the IDE and not Studio: the agent rewrites Fluent source, so it is committable.

07 Pull back to VS Code

The loop closes

```
git pull
```

Local and instance agree, and Git holds every version in between.

If it doesn't work

SYMPTOM	CAUSE
Clone Git repository fails in the IDE	The PAT is not scoped to that repository, or lacks contents read and write
Pull succeeded, artifact still missing	You pulled but skipped Build and Install — step 05
The repo fills up with XML	Studio is linked to source control, not the IDE. The SDK cannot consume that XML
A teammate's install disappears	One shared dev instance, no sandbox. Serialize installs, or split artifacts across branches
Scoped app behaves differently	Untested here. Global scope exists on every instance, a custom scope may not

Two forks, and where the other path goes

FORK 1 · INSTALL SURFACE

We installed from the IDE

The instance builds from its own clone of the repo, so nothing has to be installed from a laptop and no sandbox is needed.

Use **local now-sdk install** instead when you own the dev instance outright. Neither route is a production path: test and production install the published version from Application Repository.

FORK 2 · SOURCE CONTROL SURFACE

We used the IDE Git clone

The repo holds Fluent, so both VS Code and the instance can read and write the same source.

Linking **Studio to source control** instead pushes XML. That repo is only useful for platform side updates and deployment, and the SDK cannot round trip it.

DOCS WORTH KEEPING

- [SDLC guide](#)
- [All SDK guides](#)
- [The video this came from](#)
- [ServiceNow SDK docs](#)
- [Sample repo, SN AI Agents](#)

WHERE THIS CAME FROM

AINOW — youtube.com/@aibytusharm

Companion sheet to the **Build in VS Code, install from the IDE** video. The channel runs the full **ServiceNow SDK series** — planning, building and shipping apps with agents on the platform — plus the **Connect X to Claude Code MCP series**. Questions go in the comments.



SCAN → CHANNEL